

Matthew O'Leary

UX Designer | Making Complex Systems Human

The Pattern I've Seen Repeatedly

Engineers build incredibly sophisticated systems—smart, powerful, feature-rich.

But they design for themselves: assuming users have the same technical knowledge, expecting them to understand complex relationships immediately, presenting all features at once with equal weight.

This creates products that are brilliant but bewildering.

My role: Bridge that gap. Translate technical complexity into intuitive human experiences.

Live Price Check: Simplifying Complex Data

Engineer-Designed: Data Overload

The interface displays a list of retailers on the left, including Amazon.co.uk, Currys, AO.com, Appliances Direct, and others. The main area shows three refrigerator products with detailed specifications and prices.

Product	Price	Features
Hotpoint RLA38P Under Counter Fridge - White	From £180.00	Size H85.0, W59.8, D62.0cm Fresh food capacity (L) 146
Beko LSG3545W Tall Fridge - White	£310.00	Size H145.7, W54.0, D57.5cm Fresh food capacity (L) 252 Frost free
Bush ME55R5UCF Under Counter Fridge	£160.00	

Simplified: Clear Hierarchy

The interface displays a clear hierarchy of products and prices for irons and steamers. It includes a search bar, a list of products with images, and a table of prices from various retailers.

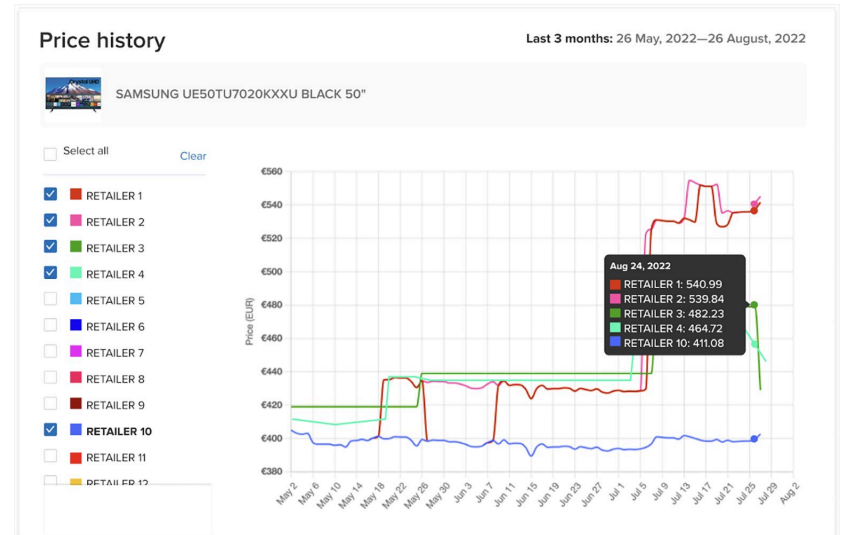
Product	Price	Features
Russell Hobbs Powersteam Ultra Vertical Steam Iron 20630	£55.70	34.0% higher than lowest offer
Philips GC4902 Azur Steam Iron	£90.00	293 reviews
Russell Hobbs Speedglide PRO Steam Iron 23970	£28.00	240 reviews

Live Price Check: Making Data Scannable

Before: Unclear Legend - No Ability to Interact



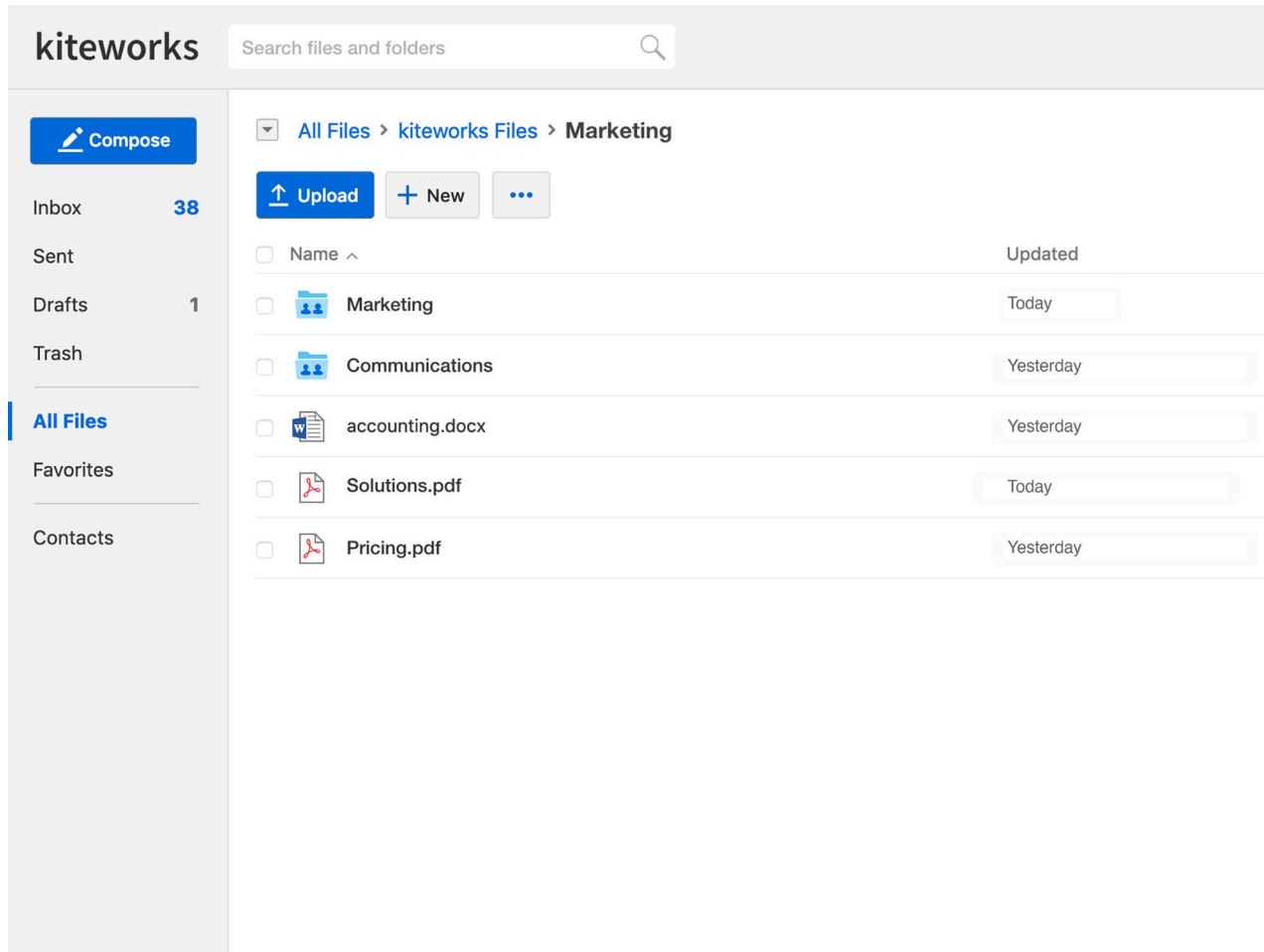
After: Obvious Legend and Ability to Customize



How I Make Technical Products Human

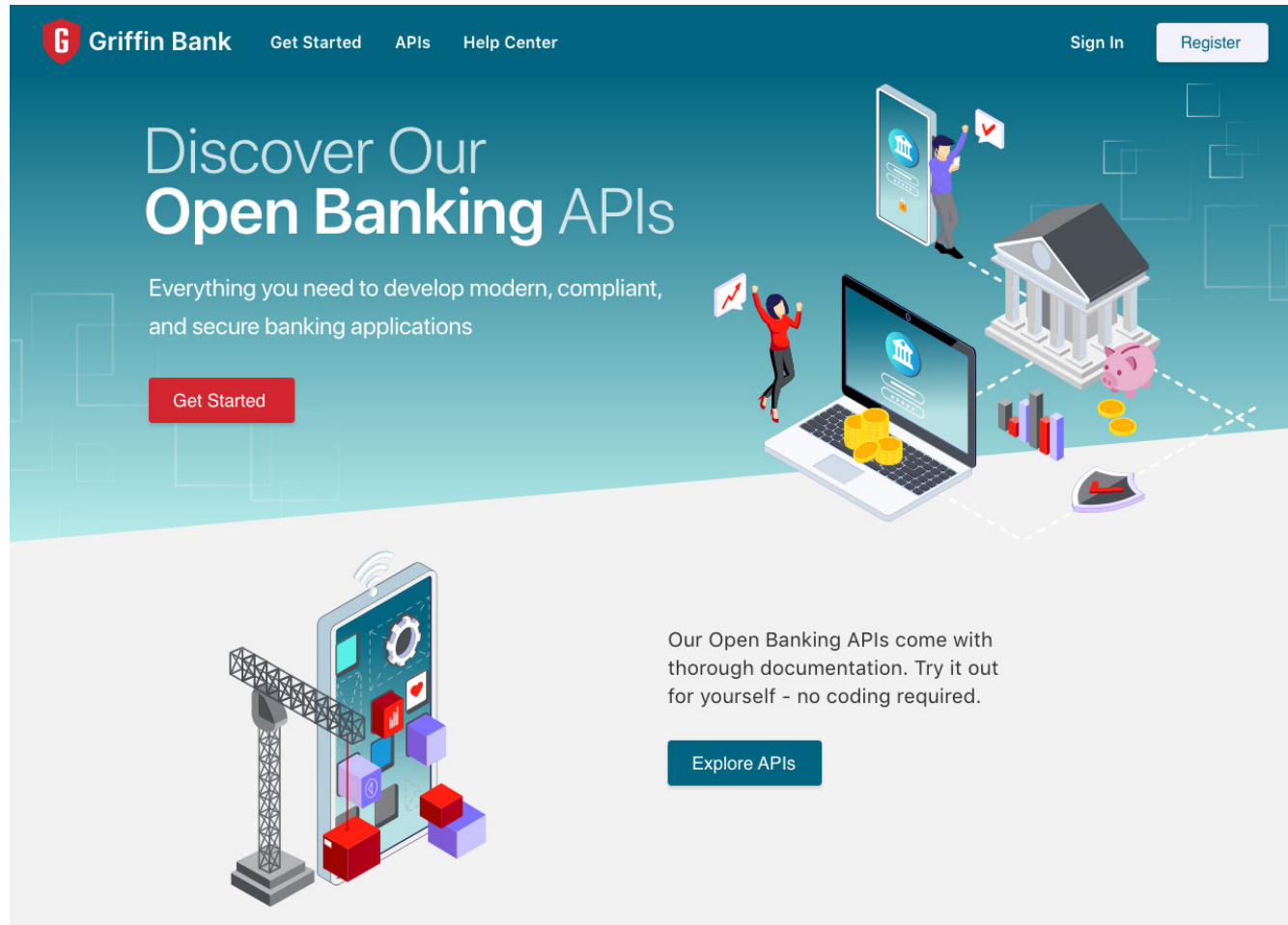
- Ruthless simplification: Remove cognitive load, surface only what matters now
- Progressive disclosure: Guide users from simple to complex, reveal features as they're needed
- Clear information hierarchy: Show relationships, not just features
- Collaboration with engineering: Respect technical constraints while advocating for users
- Iterative refinement: Test, learn, simplify further

Kiteworks: Enterprise File Sharing



Clean, intuitive interface for complex permission systems and secure collaboration

Open Banking: Fintech Platform Design



Designed developer-facing banking APIs and integration flows

Where I've Applied This Approach

Kiteworks – Enterprise file sharing & collaboration platform

- Redesigned complex permission systems and sharing workflows for non-technical users

Open Banking (Axway) – Fintech data aggregation platform

- Simplified bank connection flows and financial data visualization

Live Price Check – Retail pricing intelligence SaaS

- Created intuitive dashboards from complex competitive pricing data
- Transformed engineer-designed data tables into scannable, actionable interfaces

Why I'm Right for This Role

Job Requirements:

- Bridge system architecture and UX ✓

I've done this repeatedly

- Transform complex requirements into intuitive patterns ✓

This is my core skill

- Compliance & regulatory flows ✓

Enterprise experience with legal constraints

- Design systems maintenance ✓

My Differentiators:

- 10+ years UX across SaaS, fintech, enterprise

- Deep technical knowledge—I code (HTML/CSS/JS, modern frameworks)

- Production mindset—understand implementation constraints

- Commerce experience—designed checkout/payment flows

- Proven stakeholder collaboration

My Recent Path

2022-2024: Transitioned from full-time UX to entrepreneurial projects

- Launched Walk Santa Cruz (historical tour business) - designed entire customer journey
- Maintained technical skills: built sites with Astro.js, Tailwind CSS, modern workflows
- Freelance web design - kept design thinking sharp across varied projects
- Stayed current: AI-assisted workflows, modern design/dev tools

Why return to enterprise UX?

I miss working on complex systems at scale. I miss collaborating with brilliant engineering teams. I miss solving hard UX problems that impact millions of users.

What You Get From Day One

- Immediate productivity: I've designed these flows before (trials, pricing, cancellations)
- Engineering partnership: I understand technical constraints and speak their language
- User advocacy with pragmatism: I push for users without creating impossible requirements
- Design systems thinking: I build for scale and reusability
- Global perspective: Experience with international markets and accessibility

About My Portfolio

Full transparency: I don't have a traditional case study portfolio.

Like many experienced designers who focused on shipping products rather than documenting process, my work lives in production systems and confidential repositories.

What I can provide:

- Detailed walkthrough conversations about my process and decisions
- References from directors and PMs I've worked with (including Credit Karma)
- Quick spec work on relevant problem spaces to demonstrate current thinking
- My live portfolio site showing range across digital/print/web

Let's Talk

I've spent 10+ years making engineer-brilliant products human-simple.

This role is exactly that: complex commerce systems, regulatory requirements, global scale—all needing intuitive user experiences.

I'm ready to dig in, collaborate with your teams, and ship designs that make a difference.

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